

into an empty swivel chair. He was swiveling himself while talking on the phone. Something was off five-eighths, which apparently was all right, because I heard him say, "People took some profits, so she jumped down, but there's support there, you're still in the right direction."

As I swiveled in rhythm with his swivels, waiting for him to hang up, my eyes wandered to a telephone Rolodex opened to a little reminder that said, CONFIDENTIAL. SPEAK SLOWLY, CLEARLY AND BE COURTEOUS. CONFIDENCE IS 50 PERCENT OF THE SALE." Suddenly he wheeled around, winked, put his hand on my knee, and introduced himself as Bryan Nemerov all in a continuous swoop. He looked 25, a little bowling ball of a man with a mustache. In a breathless staccato, he explained he'd been a stockbroker for several months, having drifted over from men's wear and before that women's wear. A certificate from his broker's course, the Thomson McKinnon Total Money Management Program, was visible on his half-wall.

We were interrupted by several other phone calls from clients, including two from his aunt, who was worried about Twistee Treat. "Don't worry," he said, "a good long-term hold. Did you read the paper this morning? Dick Davis mentioned TT in his column." Another snippet I heard was, "Six and a quarter already? That's moving! I'm glad you're in there."

When I finally got to ask Mr. Nemerov what he'd done to recommend himself, he said nothing about stocks, bonds, or any clients who'd made money on his advice. Instead he opened his desk drawer to show me a commendation he'd received for attracting the most new IRA accounts to his firm. I probed further for his investment ideas. He said he got most of them from *Forbes* and a couple of other business magazines. The search for new clients, he lamented, left him little time to think about investments.

Exaggerating a bit to enhance my importance, I told him I had about \$50,000 to invest. He wondered if I was "growth oriented." I assured him I definitely was "growth-oriented," if by "growth" he meant "profit." He said he did. Then he asked if I was "short-term" or "long-term." Perhaps because I gave no clue as to which I might prefer, Mr. Nemerov said he was both.

"You're growth-oriented," he continued. "I like that. I'd prob-